

Cura

A field study in care.

A slow-fashion pop-up built on a single word, care. For what we make, what we choose, and the world it all comes from.

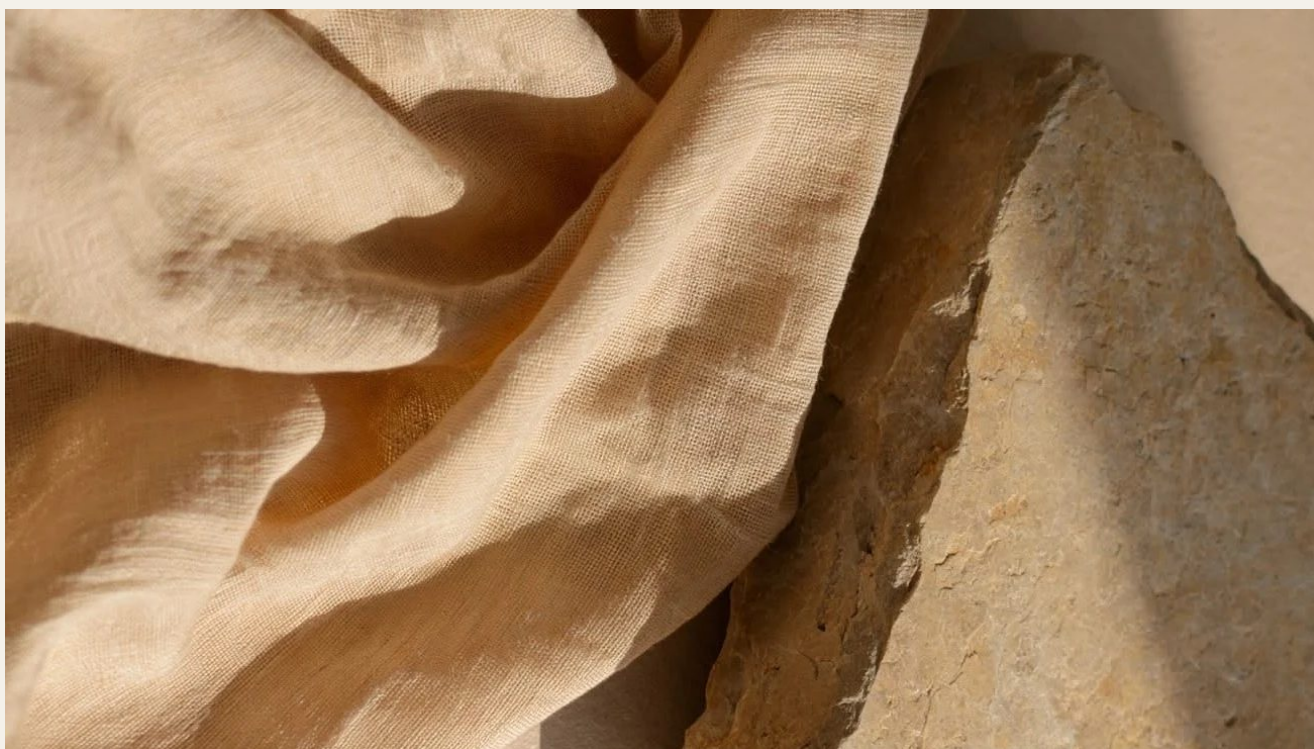


Plate 01 — linen, light and stone [[enlarge](#)]

THE LIVE INTERACTIVE EXHIBIT

liv-sanchez-interiors.netlify.app

Open the link above to walk the exhibit, click any image to enlarge it, and play the films. Every image in this document also links to its full size online.

Liv Sanchez Interiors · Small Commercial Project · SDS 0902

Introducing Cura

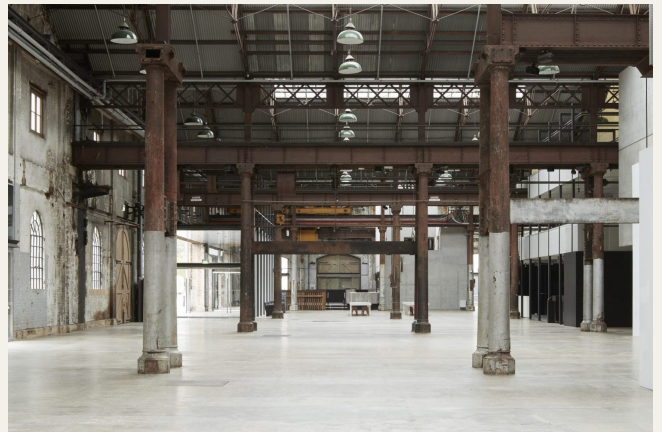
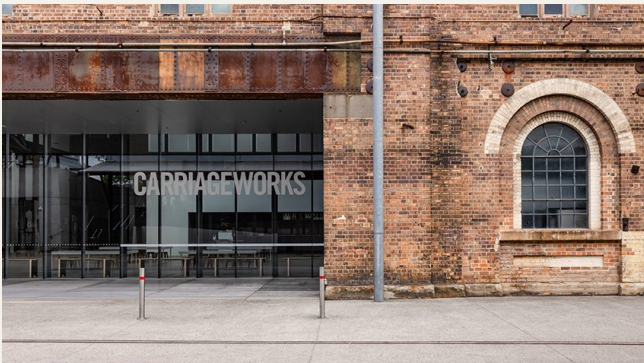
Cura is a slow-fashion and lifestyle pop-up, and everything about it comes back to one word, **care**. Care for the materials, for the craft behind them, and for the environment that yields them. It sits inside Carriageworks in Eveleigh as part of Sydney Festival, with a simple intent: to make people slow down for a moment, actually touch and notice natural materials, and leave with something they have made themselves.

The experience is built in two interlocking parts, a curated retail edit and a hands-on personalisation studio, so buying and making sit side by side. You arrive a browser and leave a maker, carrying a piece you have a real connection to.

The site and the idea

The brief asked for a temporary pop-up at Carriageworks: a commercial zone and an interactive zone, sustainability front and centre, and at least three of the senses engaged.

Carriageworks is a 19th-century brick rail workshop, all exposed brick, repeating iron-framed gabled bays and raw industrial volume. That rawness pushed the whole project towards a grounded, earthy material direction. The Festival crowd is culturally switched-on, inner-city and values-driven, so slow fashion felt like exactly the right fit.



The heritage brick and steel exterior, and the iron columns and gabled trusses within [\[enlarge \]](#)

Two artists shaped the direction

Janet Laurence gave the **why**: glass, botanicals and veils, nature as care. Kengo Kuma gave the **how**: layered bamboo and soft, filtered light. From there the name **Cura**, Latin for care, simply landed. The design response is an organic, curved 80 m² plan with two interlocking zones, two ways in and out, four senses engaged, and a full zero-landfill plan for when the pop-up comes down.



Janet Laurence, the why · Kengo Kuma, the how [\[enlarge \]](#)

The customer is into slow fashion and conscious living: largely female, 25 to 45, inner-city Sydney, who values a tactile experience and genuinely cares about where things come from.

Concept board

The board pulls from the natural world, earth, botanicals, craft and light, chosen to carry the *feeling* of care more than the literal fact of it.



Textures of care: raw linen, water, glazed clay, leaf vein, pressed botanicals, rammed earth and filtered light [\[enlarge \]](#)

Two zones, one journey

One curved path, browse to make. The retail edit is the outer ring; the personalisation studio sits at the heart.

Zone 01 – the retail edit, outer ring

Garments, textiles and a few lifestyle pieces. Two curved garment rails, a round travertine-look display bench, recycled-timber floating shelves, cream limewash plaster walls, sheer linen drapes, backlit herbarium vellum panels, and a change room behind block-out curtains.

Zone 02 – the personalisation studio, inner

Where it gets hands-on. Visitors customise a raw-linen piece with botanical printing and natural dyes, then take it home. A cashier counter, a personalisation bar with a rammed-earth base and FSC spotted-gum slab top, raw timber stools, and glazed botanical displays along both walls.



Mood board: the feel of the space, earthen interiors, curved counters, bamboo and linen [\[enlarge \]](#)



The offering: naturally dyed and botanically printed linen, the piece you take home [\[enlarge \]](#)

Four senses engaged

One more than the brief asked for.

Sight

Warm rammed-earth tones and sandy ochre; light through the bamboo screens and linen drapes; backlit herbarium panels and glazed botanical displays.

Touch

Rammed-earth walls, the FSC spotted-gum bench top, raw-linen garments and the travertine-look plinth, surfaces you want to run a hand over.

Smell

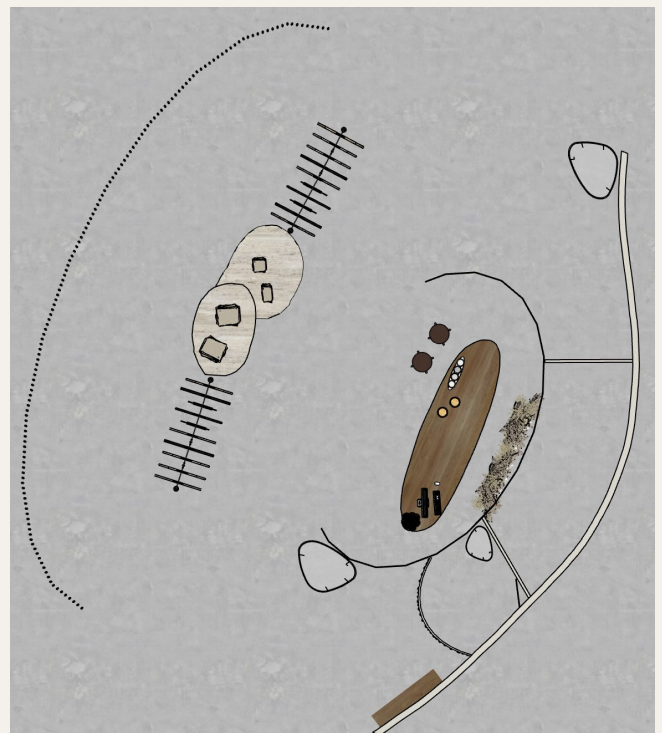
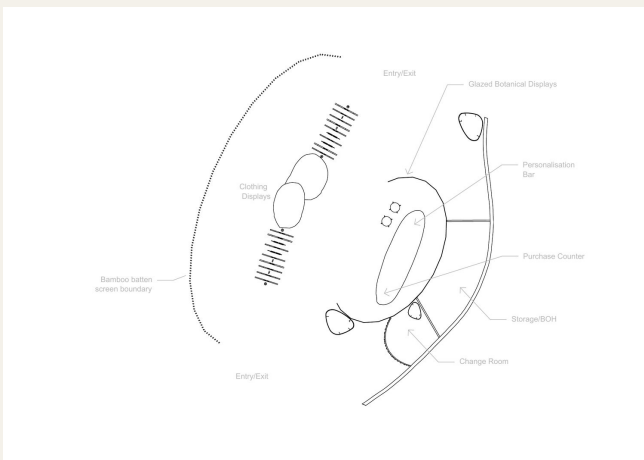
Raw earth and clay, the natural dyes working during the workshop, dried botanicals, and FSC timber.

Sound

Quiet, nature-layered background music carried softly across both zones.

The plan

An organic, curved plan across 80 m², two interlocking zones with a soft boundary between them and entry from either side. You arrive in Zone 1, move through the retail edit, then drift inward to Zone 2. The existing polished-concrete floor stays exactly as it is.



Labelled plan, and the rendered plan: retail edit as the outer ring, studio at the heart [\[enlarge \]](#)

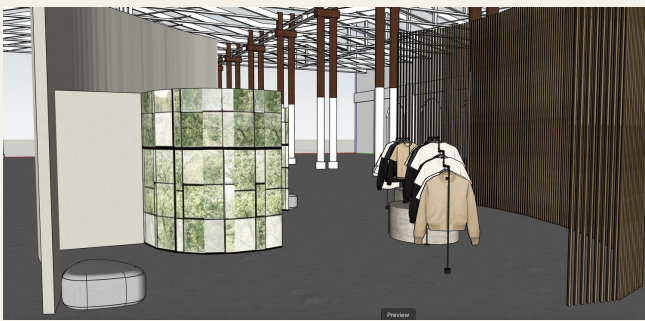
Elevations and perspectives

The space, rendered and in section. The customer journey, end to end: arrive, browse the edit, slip through the batten screen, personalise a linen piece, and head off with it.

Perspectives

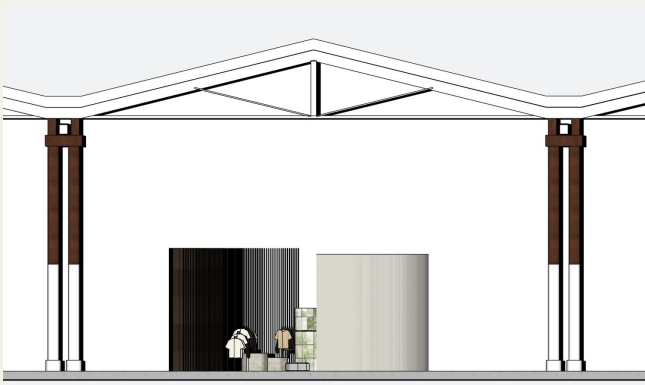


Inside the retail edit: garment rails, the glazed botanical cylinder and the bamboo screens [\[enlarge \]](#)



The glazed botanical cylinder · the personalisation counter with botanicals overhead [\[enlarge \]](#)

Elevations



The insertion under the gabled iron trusses · the glazed botanical window and the bamboo screen [\[enlarge \]](#)

Two atmosphere films (the retail front and the personalisation bar) and the full walkthrough play in the live exhibit at the link on the cover.

Schedule of finishes, furniture and fixtures

Eighteen line items. The three finishes carried all the way through to full sustainability research are marked FEATURED.

Code	Item	Application	Supplier	Cost
Finishes				
F-01	Cream Limewash Plaster, Rockcote [FEATURED]	Walls, retail	Rockcote	~\$85 / 15L
F-02	Rammed Earth, ochre / terracotta [FEATURED]	Walls, studio	Rammed Earth Constructions	POA
F-03	FSC Spotted Gum Hardwood Slab	Counter top	Big River Group	~\$180 / m2
F-04	FSC Engineered Bamboo, SeaChange [FEATURED]	Cladding & screens	House of Bamboo	~\$120 / m2
F-05	Polished Concrete, retained	Floor throughout	Existing	Nil
F-06	FR Linen-Look Sheer Curtains	Retail curtains	Warwick Fabrics	POA
F-07	FR Linen-Look Block-Out Curtains	Change room	Warwick Fabrics	POA
F-08	Backlit Herbarium Vellum Panels	Feature panels	Spicers Paper	POA
Furniture				
FF-01	Blackened Steel Curved Rails	Retail zone	Midalia Steel	POA
FF-02	Recycled Timber Floating Shelves	Display shelving	Designwood	~\$195 / unit
FF-03	Circular Travertine-Look Bench	Central plinth	Hammond & Grange	~\$650 / unit
FF-04	Raw Timber Bar Stools	Counter seating	Trit House	~\$430 to \$1,125
FF-05	Commercial Ottomans	Zone & change-room seating	GlobeWest	POA
Lighting, all 2700K warm white LED				
L-01	Adjustable Track Spotlights	Accent, retail	Euroluce	POA
L-02	LED Strip behind Botanical Panels	Backlit panels	Domus FINO	POA
L-03	Concealed LED in Ceiling Batten	Ceiling	Brightgreen	POA
L-04	Narrow Wash Uplighters	Bamboo screens	Inlite	POA
L-05	Recessed LED under Counter	Counter lip	Domus Lighting	POA

Costs indicative. POA = price on application. The existing concrete floor is retained, so no new material and no cost.

Three materials, followed cradle to grave

The finishes that carry the sustainability story, traced from how they are made to where they end up.

01 SEACHANGE SERIES, HOUSE OF BAMBOO

FSC Engineered Bamboo

WHERE	The vertical screen between the zones.
IMPACT	FSC and Global GreenTag certified, rapidly renewable, sequesters more carbon than most timbers.
HOW IT IS MADE	Stalks harvested, stripped, compressed and heat-bonded into boards, then cut to a batten profile.
END OF LIFE	Returned via the House of Bamboo take-back scheme. Zero landfill.

02 OCHRE AND TERRACOTTA, RAMMED EARTH CONSTRUCTIONS

Rammed Earth

WHERE	The personalisation-bar base in Zone 2; sets the Cura palette.
IMPACT	Zero VOC, no synthetic additives, extremely low embodied energy.
HOW IT IS MADE	Raw earth, clay and natural pigment compacted in layers within formwork. No firing, no chemicals.
END OF LIFE	Broken down and literally returned to earth. Zero waste.

03 CREAM LIMEWASH, ROCKCOTE

Rockcote Limewash Plaster

WHERE	The curved walls throughout Zone 1.
IMPACT	Zero VOC, fully natural and breathable, with no harmful off-gassing.
HOW IT IS MADE	Limestone burned to lime putty, mixed with water and natural pigment. Self-healing micro-cracks.
END OF LIFE	Fully biodegradable, returned to earth after use.

When the pop-up comes down

Every part of the build has somewhere to go after three weeks. Nothing is made just to be binned.

Rammed-earth counter	Broken down, returned to earth
FSC timber bench and slab	Demounted, reused
Bamboo cladding and screens	Returned via take-back scheme
Dried botanicals	Composted or donated
Glazed botanical displays	Glass reused, specimens composted
Linen curtains	Donated
Blackened-steel rails	Reused
All LED lighting	Reused
Recycled timber shelves	Reused or donated
Travertine-look plinth	Reused
Ottomans	Reused or donated
Vellum botanical panels	Composted

Target: zero landfill.

Self-evaluation

To complete after educator feedback. Four questions to answer:

- What was successful about the design?
- What changes would better communicate the concept?
- What were the challenges in translating concept into space?
- How would I improve my concept-development process?

The complete interactive exhibit, with the walkthrough and atmosphere films, lives at liv-sanchez-interiors.netlify.app.